

# CHILD SAFEGUARDING POLICY



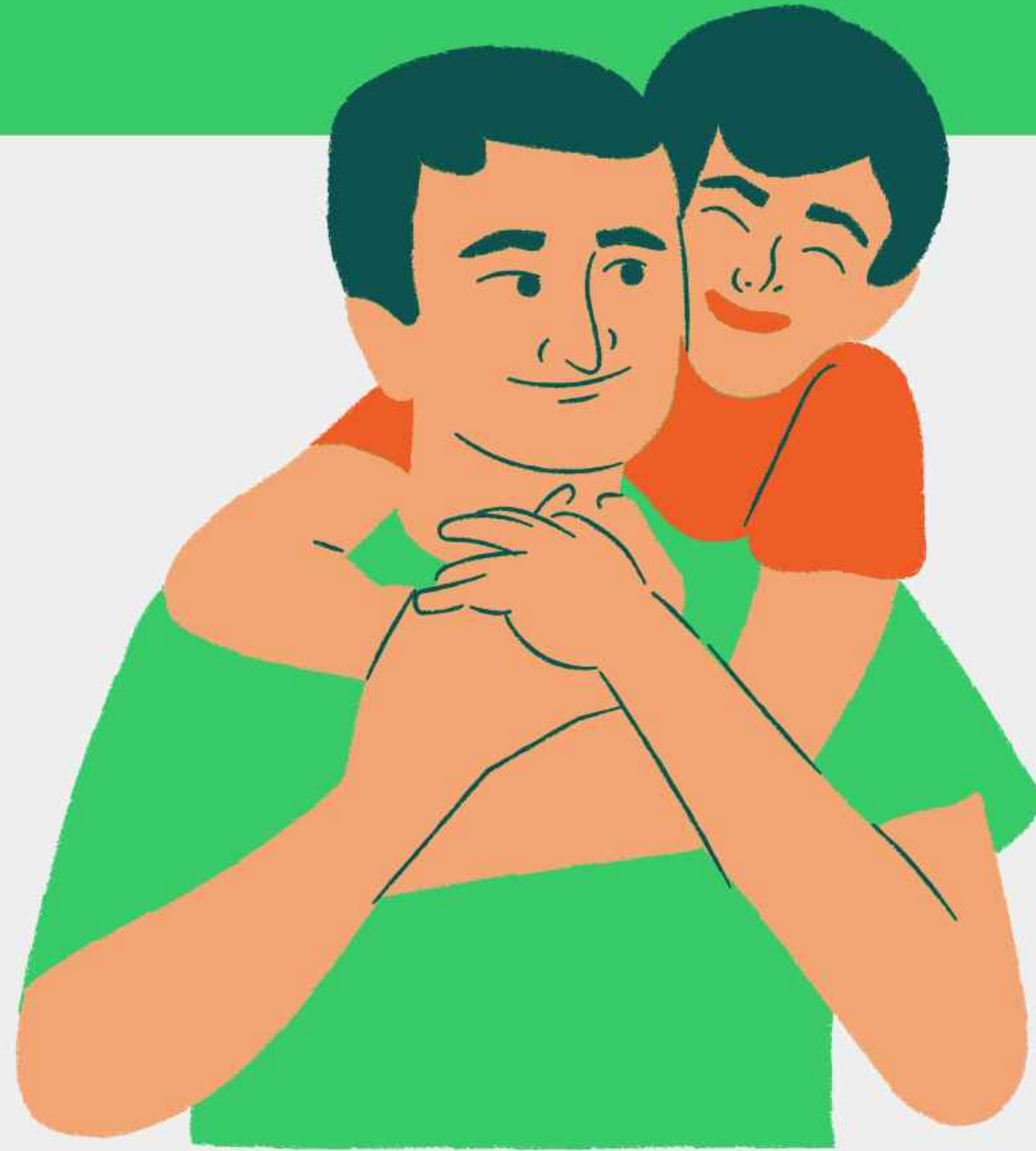
# Child Safeguarding Policy

CRY's Child Safeguarding Policy is a clear and powerful commitment to protect every child from harm whether physical, emotional, sexual, or through neglect. Safeguarding means creating safe environments where children are respected, nurtured, and free to grow without fear. This policy ensures that every adult associated with CRY—staff, volunteers, or partners knows how to act responsibly and ethically around children. It leaves no space for abuse or misconduct. Anyone who violates these standards will face serious consequences under both CRY's internal systems and the law. Because at CRY, protecting children is not optional — it's a promise.



# Purpose

- The core purpose of CRY's Child Safeguarding Policy is simple yet powerful. It ensures that every child is treated with dignity, respect, and love
- This policy serves as a clear and unified guide that reminds us that working with children is not just a responsibility, but a deep human commitment
- It makes sure that child protection is woven into the very fabric of every action and decision we take
- It lays down non-negotiable standards of behavior and ensures that there is zero tolerance for abuse of any kind and stand by every child



## Core Values

- Every child is equal and deserves respect as guaranteed by UNCRC
- The well-being of the child comes first, always
- Children have voices and we must listen to them regardless of background, gender, ability, caste, class
- All forms of abuse are completely unacceptable, without exception
- Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility





## Positive Practices

- Treat every child with respect and kindness
- Always respect their privacy and personal space
- Ensure the environment is safe and inclusive
- Maintain clear professional boundaries
- Handle personal information with care and get proper consent
- Be a role model—empathetic, responsible, and trustworthy in every interaction



# Prohibited Behaviour

- Never use physical punishment or threatening behavior
- Avoid inappropriate touching or private one-on-one situations
- Do not form personal relationships with children or their families
- Never bully, shame, or emotionally manipulate a child
- Don't share a child's photos or details without consent
- Always act in ways that protect a child's dignity and safety



# Responsibilities & Implementation

- At CRY, Child safeguarding is a shared responsibility. Every individual at CRY — staff, volunteers, interns, and partners — plays an essential role in keeping children safe
- Training is provided to everyone. CRY ensures that all team members are equipped to recognize, prevent, report and respond to any signs of harm or abuse.
- Thorough background checks are mandatory. Before working with children, each individual is screened to maintain a safe and trustworthy environment
- Any concern must be reported within 24 hours. If one witnesses or even suspects abuse, it's one's duty to report it promptly and responsibly
- CRY acts swiftly — within 48 hours
- The organization takes immediate and sensitive action to protect the child and investigate the situation
- Together, we create a safe and empowering space. By staying alert, compassionate, and accountable, we help every child feel safe, heard, and truly valued

# Legal Foundation

"The Child Safeguarding Policy of CRY is firmly anchored in the legal framework of India, ensuring adherence to statutory obligations and reinforcing the organization's accountability in protecting every child's rights and well-being."

- POCSO Act, 2012: Protects children from sexual abuse, harassment, and pornography; mandates mandatory reporting by individuals and institutions
- Juvenile Justice Act, 2015: Addresses care, protection, adoption, and rehabilitation; includes clear punishment for cruelty, neglect, and abuse
- Right to Education Act, 2009: Prohibits physical punishment and mental harassment in schools; upholds a safe and inclusive learning environment

- Child Labour (Prohibition & Regulation) Act, 1986: Bans employment of children in hazardous jobs; sets working conditions for adolescents
- Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006: Declares child marriage illegal; punishes those involved or who fail to prevent it
- IT Act & Media Guidelines: Ban online sexual content involving children; protect child identity in all media



# Conclusion

CRY's Child Safeguarding Policy stands as a heartfelt promise — a promise that no child will ever be left unheard, unprotected, or unseen.

It is not just a set of rules, but a living commitment to building a world where children can grow up with dignity, joy, and freedom from fear. This policy weaves together law, ethics, and compassion — guiding every action, every interaction.

Each one of us has a role to play. Whether you're a staff member, volunteer, or partner, your awareness and integrity matter deeply. When you uphold this policy, you become a part of a larger mission — to protect childhood itself.

Safeguarding is not just about preventing harm; it's about creating a safe space where trust is built, voices are heard, and children can thrive — safely, freely, and fully.

Together, we can help children not just survive, but live with strength, hope, and confidence in a world that believes in them.

THANK YOU

PROTECTING CHILDREN  
IS EVERYBODY'S BUSINESS

